

Class	Common Drugs	Typical Indications	Example Adult Dose	Major Side Effects	Major Interactions	OTC/Rx?
Analgesics/NSAIDs	Paracetamol (acetaminophen), ibuprofen, low-dose codeine preparations (co-codamol), aspirin	Pain (headache, arthritis), fever	Paracetamol 500 mg × 1–2 every 4 h (max 4 g/24h); Ibuprofen 200–400 mg × 3/day (max 1200 mg OTC)	<i>Paracetamol</i> : rare side effects at normal doses; overdose → hepatic failure. <i>NSAIDs</i> : GI irritation/bleeding, renal strain, hypertension, headache	Warfarin (↑bleeding), lithium (↑Li), antihypertensives (NSAIDs reduce effect)	Paracetamol & ibuprofen – OTC (max 10 d use); Codeine mixtures – OTC (low-strength) or Rx; Strong opioids – Rx only
Antibiotics	Amoxicillin, doxycycline, flucloxacillin	Bacterial infections (respiratory, skin, UTI)	Amoxicillin 500 mg × 3/day (500–1000 mg)	GI upset (nausea, diarrhea), rash, yeast infections (from PPIs, but antibiotics often cause GI)	Oral contraceptives (some reduced efficacy), warfarin (↑effect with many antibiotics)	Prescription only (not OTC)
Antihistamines	Cetirizine, loratadine (2nd gen); chlorphenamine (1st gen)	Allergic rhinitis, urticaria, itch	Cetirizine 10 mg once daily	Sedation/fatigue (esp. 1st gen), dry mouth, headache, dizziness	Alcohol or CNS depressants (potentiate sedation)	OTC (non-drowsy types); some (first-gen) Rx
Gastrointestinal	Omeprazole, lansoprazole (PPIs); antacids (aluminum/magnesium, alginates)	Heartburn, GORD, PUD	Omeprazole 20 mg once daily (up to 40 mg)	Headache, GI upset, diarrhoea/constipation, B12 malabsorption (long-term)	Clopidogrel (CYP interaction), atazanavir (absorption with PPIs)	PPI (20 mg short course OTC; higher doses Rx); Antacids – OTC
Antiemetics	Ondansetron, prochlorperazine, metoclopramide	Nausea, vomiting (e.g. motion sickness, gastroenteritis, post-op)	Ondansetron 4–8 mg every 8 h (IV or oral)	Ondansetron: headache, constipation; metoclopramide: extrapyramidal effects, sedation	Ondansetron: QT-prolonging drugs; Metoclopramide: anticholinergics	Ondansetron – Rx; Dimenhydrinate (for motion sickness) – OTC
Laxatives/Anti-Diarrheals	Lactulose, senna (laxatives); loperamide (Imodium)	Constipation (laxative); acute diarrhea (loperamide)	Lactulose 15–30 mL daily; Senna 2–4 tablets HS; Loperamide 2 mg initially,	Lactulose/senna: bloating, cramps; Loperamide: constipation, drowsiness	Senna: minimal; Loperamide: avoid with antiarrhythmics (high dose may	All OTC (loperamide: up to 16 mg/day OTC)

			then 1 mg per loose stool		cause arrhythmia)	
Antihypertensives	Lisinopril (ACE inhibitor), atenolol (beta-blocker), amlodipine (CCB)	Hypertension, heart failure (ACEi), angina (beta/CCB)	Lisinopril 10–40 mg once daily	ACEi (lisinopril): cough, dizziness, hyperkalaemia; beta-blocker: fatigue, bronchospasm; CCB: edema	ACEi + K-sparing diuretics (hyperkalaemia); NSAIDs (ACEi effect)	Rx only (no OTC)
Lipid-Lowering	Simvastatin, atorvastatin	High cholesterol (primary/secondary prevention)	Simvastatin 10–40 mg once daily (evening)	Headache, GI upset, muscle aches (myopathy); rare rhabdomyolysis	Fibrates (↑myopathy risk), CYP3A4 inhibitors (e.g. some antibiotics)	Rx only (no OTC statins in UK)
Antidepressants (SSRIs)	Sertraline, fluoxetine	Depression, anxiety disorders, OCD, PTSD	Sertraline 25–200 mg once daily (start low)	Nausea, headache, insomnia, sexual dysfunction, weight change	MAOIs (serotonin syndrome), other serotonergic drugs; SSRIs + NSAIDs (↑GI bleed risk)	Rx only
Bronchodilators	Salbutamol (beta-agonist), ipratropium (anticholinergic)	Asthma/COPD relief (acute wheeze)	Salbutamol inhaler: 100–200 mcg (1–2 puffs) as needed	Tremor, tachycardia, headache	Beta-blockers (counteract effect); additive tachycardia with other stimulants	Salbutamol: inhaler Rx (some hand-held nebulizer solutions OTC in UK)
Topical Dermatologics	Clotrimazole cream, hydrocortisone cream	Fungal skin infections (athlete's foot, ringworm); mild eczema/dermatitis	Clotrimazole cream: apply 2–3×/day for 2–4 weeks; Hydrocortisone 1% cream: apply 1–2×/day	Local irritation, burning or rash; long-term steroids: skin thinning	Minimal systemic interactions; caution if applying near eyes	Both OTC (low-strength)

Generic Name	Common Brand Names	Common Use	Notes
Domperidone	Domstal, Motilium	Nausea, vomiting, gastric fullness	Usually before meals
Ondansetron	Zofran, Emeset	Strong nausea/vomiting	Often prescription-only
Metoclopramide	Maxolon	Vomiting, gastric reflux	Can affect nervous system
Dimenhydrinate	Dramamine	Motion sickness	Causes drowsiness

About Domperidone

What it is used for

- Vomiting
- Nausea
- Gastric fullness
- Bloating
- Reflux symptoms

General usage awareness

- Commonly taken **before meals**
- Usually short-term use
- Tablet or syrup forms available

Common side effects

- Dry mouth
- Stomach cramps
- Headache
- Dizziness

Important warning

Domperidone can affect heart rhythm in some people, especially:

- Elderly patients

- People with heart disease
- Those taking multiple medicines

That is why many doctors avoid long-term or unnecessary use.

MAIN MEDICINE CATEGORIES (Beginner Pharmacy Core)

Pain & Fever

Category	Purpose	Example
Analgesics	Pain relief	Paracetamol
NSAIDs	Pain + inflammation	Ibuprofen
Antipyretics	Fever reduction	Paracetamol

Stomach & Digestive

Category	Purpose
Antacids	Reduce stomach acid
PPIs	Strong acid reduction
H2 blockers	Acid reduction
Antiemetics	Vomiting/nausea
Antidiarrheals	Diarrhea
Laxatives	Constipation
Antispasmodics	Stomach cramps

Examples:

- Omeprazole
- Domperidone
- Loperamide

Allergy & Cold

Category	Purpose
Antihistamines	Allergy
Decongestants	Blocked nose
Cough suppressants	Dry cough
Expectorants	Wet cough

Examples:

- Cetirizine
- Loratadine

Antibiotics

Huge category.

Subcategory	Example
Penicillins	Amoxicillin
Macrolides	Azithromycin
Cephalosporins	Cephalexin
Fluoroquinolones	Ciprofloxacin

Antifungals

Purpose	Example
Skin fungal infections	Clotrimazole
Severe fungal infections	Fluconazole

Blood Pressure Medicines

Category	Example
ACE inhibitors	Enalapril
ARBs	Losartan
Beta blockers	Propranolol
Calcium channel blockers	Amlodipine

Diabetes Medicines

Category	Example
Biguanides	Metformin
Insulin	Insulin

Cholesterol Medicines

Category	Example
Statins	Atorvastatin

Examples:

- Salbutamol
- Budesonide

Respiratory Medicines

Category	Purpose
Bronchodilators	Open airways
Steroid inhalers	Reduce airway inflammation

Skin Medicines

Category	Purpose
Corticosteroids	Reduce inflammation
Antifungals	Fungal infections
Antibiotic creams	Skin infections

Vitamins & Supplements

Category	Example
Iron	Ferrous sulfate
Calcium	Calcium carbonate
Multivitamins	Various

Hormonal Medicines

Category	Example
Thyroid medicines	Levothyroxine
Steroids	Prednisolone

Real Pharmacist Trick

Experienced pharmacists don't memorize every medicine individually.

They recognize:

- Suffixes
- Categories
- Patterns

Example:

- “-prazole” → gastric medicine
- “-statin” → cholesterol
- “-cillin” → antibiotic
- “-sartan” → blood pressure

This is why category-based learning is powerful.

Stage 1 — MOST COMMON MEDICINE CATEGORIES

1. Pain Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Pain relief
- Fever reduction
- Inflammation reduction

Main Categories

Category	Purpose	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Analgesics	Pain relief	Paracetamol	No fixed suffix
NSAIDs	Pain + inflammation	Ibuprofen, Diclofenac, Naproxen	Often “-fen”, “-xicam”
Opioids	Strong pain	Tramadol, Codeine	“-dol”, others

Common Suffixes

- **-fen** → Ibuprofen, Ketoprofen
- **-xicam** → Piroxicam, Meloxicam

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2. Gastric Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Gastric
- Acid reflux
- Heartburn
- Ulcers
- Indigestion

Main Categories

Category	Purpose	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Antacids	Neutralize acid	Aluminum hydroxide, Magnesium hydroxide	None
PPIs	Strong acid reduction	Omeprazole, Pantoprazole, Esomeprazole	-prazole
H2 Blockers	Reduce acid	Famotidine	-tidine
Mucosal protectants	Protect stomach	Sucralfate	None

Common Suffixes

- **-prazole** → Gastric acid medicines
- **-tidine** → H2 blockers

3. Allergy Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Allergy
- Sneezing
- Itching
- Rashes

Main Categories

Category	Purpose	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Antihistamines	Allergy relief	Cetirizine, Loratadine, Chlorpheniramine	Often “-zine”, “-adine”

Common Suffixes

- **-zine** → Cetirizine
 - **-adine** → Loratadine, Fexofenadine
-

4. Cold & Cough Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Cold
- Cough
- Blocked nose
- Flu symptoms

Main Categories

Category	Purpose	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Decongestants	Open blocked nose	Pseudoephedrine	-phrine
Cough suppressants	Reduce dry cough	Dextromethorphan	None
Expectorants	Remove mucus	Guaifenesin	-fenesin
Antihistamines	Allergy/cold symptoms	Cetirizine, Chlorpheniramine	Various

Common Suffixes

- **-phrine** → Decongestants
 - **-fenesin** → Expectorants
-

5. Vomiting Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Vomiting
- Nausea
- Motion sickness

Main Categories

Category	Purpose	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Antiemetics	Prevent vomiting	Domperidone, Ondansetron, Metoclopramide	Often “-setron”

Common Suffixes

- **-setron** → Ondansetron
- Domperidone has no strong family suffix

6. Diarrhea Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Diarrhea
- Loose stools
- Dehydration support

Main Categories

Category	Purpose	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Antidiarrheals	Slow bowel movement	Loperamide	-amide
Rehydration	Replace fluids	ORS	None
Probiotics	Restore gut bacteria	Lactobacillus	None

7. Antibiotics

Purpose

Used for:

- Bacterial infections

IMPORTANT

Do NOT work against viruses.

Main Categories

Category	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Penicillins	Amoxicillin, Ampicillin	-cillin
Macrolides	Azithromycin, Clarithromycin	-mycin
Cephalosporins	Cephalexin, Cefuroxime	cef-/ceph-
Fluoroquinolones	Ciprofloxacin, Levofloxacin	-floxacin
Sulfa drugs	Sulfamethoxazole	sulfa-

Common Suffixes

- **-cillin** → Penicillins
 - **-mycin** → Macrolides
 - **-floxacin** → Quinolones
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8. Antifungals

Purpose

Used for:

- Fungal infections
- Ringworm
- Candida

Main Categories

Category	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Azoles	Fluconazole, Clotrimazole, Ketoconazole	-zole
Allylamines	Terbinafine	-fine

Common Suffixes

- **-zole** → Antifungals
- **-fine** → Terbinafine group

Stage 2 — CHRONIC DISEASE MEDICINES

9. Blood Pressure Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- High blood pressure
- Heart protection

Main Categories

Category	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
ACE inhibitors	Enalapril, Lisinopril	-pril
ARBs	Losartan, Valsartan	-sartan
Beta blockers	Propranolol, Atenolol	-olol
Calcium channel blockers	Amlodipine	-dipine
Diuretics	Furosemide	Often “-ide”

10. Diabetes Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Blood sugar control

Main Categories

Category	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Biguanides	Metformin	-formin
Sulfonylureas	Gliclazide, Glimepiride	-ide
DPP-4 inhibitors	Sitagliptin	-gliptin
SGLT2 inhibitors	Empagliflozin	-flozin
Insulins	Insulin	Various

11. Cholesterol Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Lower cholesterol
- Prevent heart disease

Main Categories

Category	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Statins	Atorvastatin, Rosuvastatin, Simvastatin	-statin

12. Asthma Medicines

Purpose

Used for:

- Asthma

- Wheezing
- Breathing difficulty
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Main Categories

Category	Common Medicines	Common Suffix
Bronchodilators	Salbutamol	-terol
Steroid inhalers	Budesonide, Fluticasone	-sone
Leukotriene blockers	Montelukast	-lukast

MASTER SUFFIX CHEAT SHEET

Suffix	Usually Means
-prazole	Gastric medicine
-cillin	Antibiotic
-floxacin	Antibiotic
-mycin	Antibiotic
-zole	Antifungal
-pril	BP medicine
-sartan	BP medicine
-olol	Beta blocker
-dipine	BP medicine

Suffix	Usually Means
-statin	Cholesterol medicine
-formin	Diabetes medicine
-gliptin	Diabetes medicine
-flozin	Diabetes medicine
-terol	Asthma bronchodilator
-lukast	Asthma medicine
-sone	Steroid medicine
-setron	Antivomiting medicine

Stage 1 & Stage 2 Common Medicines

1. Paracetamol

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Fever, mild pain, headache
Category	Analgesic / Antipyretic
Why Used	Reduces pain and fever
Before or After Food	Can take with or without food
Morning or Night	Any time as needed
Major Side Effects	Liver damage in overdose
Dangerous Warnings	Avoid overdose and alcohol misuse
OTC or Prescription	OTC

2. Ibuprofen

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Pain, inflammation, fever
Category	NSAID
Why Used	Reduces inflammation and pain
Before or After Food	AFTER food
Morning or Night	Usually after meals
Major Side Effects	Gastric irritation, ulcers
Dangerous Warnings	Kidney disease, gastric bleeding

Item	Details
OTC or Prescription	OTC / Pharmacy

3. Diclofenac

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Joint pain, muscle pain
Category	NSAID
Why Used	Strong anti-inflammatory effect
Before or After Food	AFTER food
Morning or Night	Usually morning/night
Major Side Effects	Gastric ulcers, kidney issues
Dangerous Warnings	Heart disease caution
OTC or Prescription	Prescription / Pharmacy

4. Tramadol

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Severe pain
Category	Opioid analgesic
Why Used	Strong pain relief
Before or After Food	With or without food
Morning or Night	As prescribed
Major Side Effects	Drowsiness, dizziness

Item	Details
Dangerous Warnings	Addiction risk, breathing suppression
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

5. Omeprazole

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Gastric, acid reflux
Category	PPI
Why Used	Reduces stomach acid
Before or After Food	BEFORE food
Morning or Night	Morning before breakfast
Major Side Effects	Headache, bloating
Dangerous Warnings	Long-term overuse issues
OTC or Prescription	OTC / Pharmacy

6. Pantoprazole

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Gastric, ulcers
Category	PPI
Why Used	Acid suppression
Before or After Food	BEFORE food

Item	Details
Morning or Night	Morning
Major Side Effects	Diarrhea, headache
Dangerous Warnings	Long-term deficiency risks
OTC or Prescription	Prescription / Pharmacy

7. Famotidine

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Heartburn, gastric
Category	H2 blocker
Why Used	Reduces acid production
Before or After Food	Before meals or night
Morning or Night	Often night
Major Side Effects	Dizziness
Dangerous Warnings	Kidney caution
OTC or Prescription	Pharmacy

8. Cetirizine

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Allergy, itching
Category	Antihistamine
Why Used	Blocks allergy histamine

Item	Details
Before or After Food	With or without food
Morning or Night	Often NIGHT
Major Side Effects	Drowsiness
Dangerous Warnings	Avoid driving if sleepy
OTC or Prescription	OTC

9. Loratadine

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Allergy, sneezing
Category	Antihistamine
Why Used	Allergy relief
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	Morning or night
Major Side Effects	Mild headache
Dangerous Warnings	Usually less drowsy
OTC or Prescription	OTC

10. Pseudoephedrine

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Blocked nose
Category	Decongestant

Item	Details
Why Used	Shrinks nasal swelling
Before or After Food	With or without food
Morning or Night	MORNING preferred
Major Side Effects	Palpitations, insomnia
Dangerous Warnings	High BP caution
OTC or Prescription	Pharmacy-only in many places

11. Dextromethorphan

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Dry cough
Category	Cough suppressant
Why Used	Reduces cough reflex
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	Often night
Major Side Effects	Drowsiness
Dangerous Warnings	Abuse potential in high doses
OTC or Prescription	OTC

12. Guaifenesin

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Wet cough

Item	Details
Category	Expectorant
Why Used	Loosens mucus
Before or After Food	After food preferred
Morning or Night	Daytime
Major Side Effects	Nausea
Dangerous Warnings	Drink plenty of water
OTC or Prescription	OTC

13. Domperidone

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Vomiting, nausea
Category	Antiemetic
Why Used	Controls nausea/vomiting
Before or After Food	BEFORE food
Morning or Night	Before meals
Major Side Effects	Dry mouth
Dangerous Warnings	Heart rhythm issues
OTC or Prescription	Prescription / Pharmacy

14. Ondansetron

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Severe nausea/vomiting
Category	Antiemetic
Why Used	Blocks vomiting signals
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	As prescribed
Major Side Effects	Constipation, headache
Dangerous Warnings	Heart rhythm caution
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

15. Metoclopramide

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Vomiting, reflux
Category	Antiemetic
Why Used	Improves stomach movement
Before or After Food	BEFORE food
Morning or Night	Before meals
Major Side Effects	Drowsiness
Dangerous Warnings	Nervous system side effects
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

16. Loperamide

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Diarrhea
Category	Antidiarrheal
Why Used	Slows bowel movement
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	As needed
Major Side Effects	Constipation
Dangerous Warnings	Avoid in bloody diarrhea
OTC or Prescription	OTC

17. Amoxicillin

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Bacterial infections
Category	Penicillin antibiotic
Why Used	Kills bacteria
Before or After Food	After food preferred
Morning or Night	Regular intervals
Major Side Effects	Diarrhea, allergy
Dangerous Warnings	Penicillin allergy
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

18. Azithromycin

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Respiratory infections
Category	Macrolide antibiotic
Why Used	Treats bacterial infections
Before or After Food	Usually before food
Morning or Night	Same time daily
Major Side Effects	Stomach upset
Dangerous Warnings	Heart rhythm risk
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

19. Ciprofloxacin

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Urinary infections
Category	Fluoroquinolone
Why Used	Broad bacterial coverage
Before or After Food	With water
Morning or Night	Regular schedule
Major Side Effects	Tendon pain
Dangerous Warnings	Tendon rupture risk
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

20. Fluconazole

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Fungal infections
Category	Azole antifungal
Why Used	Treats fungal growth
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	Any time
Major Side Effects	Nausea
Dangerous Warnings	Liver caution
OTC or Prescription	Prescription / Pharmacy

21. Terbinafine

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Ringworm, nail fungus
Category	Allylamine antifungal
Why Used	Kills fungi
Before or After Food	After food preferred
Morning or Night	Same time daily
Major Side Effects	Taste disturbance
Dangerous Warnings	Liver monitoring sometimes needed
OTC or Prescription	Pharmacy / Prescription

22. Enalapril

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	High blood pressure
Category	ACE inhibitor
Why Used	Lowers BP
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	Often morning
Major Side Effects	Dry cough
Dangerous Warnings	Pregnancy danger
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

23. Losartan

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	High blood pressure
Category	ARB
Why Used	BP control
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	Morning
Major Side Effects	Dizziness
Dangerous Warnings	Pregnancy caution
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

24. Metformin

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Type 2 diabetes
Category	Biguanide
Why Used	Lowers HIGH blood sugar
Before or After Food	AFTER food
Morning or Night	Morning + night
Major Side Effects	Diarrhea, bloating
Dangerous Warnings	Kidney disease caution
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

25. Atorvastatin

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	High cholesterol
Category	Statin
Why Used	Lowers cholesterol
Before or After Food	Any time
Morning or Night	Often NIGHT
Major Side Effects	Muscle pain
Dangerous Warnings	Liver monitoring
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

26. Salbutamol

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Asthma, wheezing
Category	Bronchodilator
Why Used	Opens airways
Before or After Food	Not food-related
Morning or Night	During symptoms
Major Side Effects	Tremors, palpitations
Dangerous Warnings	Overuse danger
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

27. Budesonide

Item	Details
Symptom/Disease	Asthma prevention
Category	Steroid inhaler
Why Used	Reduces airway inflammation
Before or After Food	Not food-related
Morning or Night	Regular daily use
Major Side Effects	Oral thrush
Dangerous Warnings	Rinse mouth after use
OTC or Prescription	Prescription

